

HAPPY PEOPLE

TEXT: Psalms 144 1 A Psalm of David. Blessed be the Lord my Rock, Who trains my hands for war, And my fingers for battle-- 2 My loving kindness and my fortress, My high tower and my deliverer, My shield and the One in whom I take refuge, Who subdues my people under me. 3 Lord, what is man, that You take knowledge of him? Or the son of man, that You are mindful of him? 4 Man is like a breath; His days are like a passing shadow. 5 Bow down Your heavens, O Lord, and come down; Touch the mountains, and they shall smoke. 6 Flash forth lightning and scatter them; Shoot out Your arrows and destroy them. 7 Stretch out Your hand from above; Rescue me and deliver me out of great waters, From the hand of foreigners, 8 Whose mouth speaks vain words, And whose right hand is a right hand of falsehood.

9 I will sing a new song to You, O God; On a harp of ten strings I will sing praises to You, 10 The One who gives salvation to kings, Who delivers David His servant From the deadly sword. 11 Rescue me and deliver me from the hand of foreigners, Whose mouth speaks lying words, And whose right hand is a right hand of falsehood-- 12 That our sons may be as plants grown up in their youth; That our daughters may be as pillars, Sculptured in palace style; 13 That our barns may be full, Supplying all kinds of produce; That our sheep may bring forth thousands And ten thousands in our fields; 14 That our oxen may be well-laden; That there be no breaking in or going out; That there be no outcry in our streets. 15 Happy are the people who are in such a state; Happy are the people whose God is the Lord!

INTRO: The word “**HAPPY**,” as used in verse 15, means “**BLESSED**.”

If you had a choice, which would you rather spend your time with, a “**HAPPY PERSON**,” or a “**SAD PERSON**?” A pessimist or an optimist?

There are certainly a lot of “**UNHAPPY PEOPLE**” both inside and outside the Church.

It is GOD’s will that His people be a “**HAPPY**” bunch of folks.

Now I want you to understand at the outset of this message that “**HAPPY PEOPLE**” are not necessarily people who live in a controlled environment where everything is perfect!

Some of the worlds “**HAPPIEST PEOPLE**” are people who have the biggest problems.

How can that be? **Psalms 144:15 “...Happy are the people whose God is the Lord.”**

In order for us to understand how it is possible to be “**HAPPY**” in spite of problems I want us to look at the example of the Psalmist David.

The four preceding Psalms seem to have been penned by David before his ascension to the throne of Israel.

It is quite possible that Psalms 140-143 were written during the time that David was being persecuted at the hand of King Saul.

However, I believe this particular Psalm was penned after his ascension to the throne. There are two verses here that lend themselves to that conclusion; **“(2) My loving kindness and my fortress, My high tower and my deliverer, My shield and the One in whom I take refuge, Who subdues my people under me. (10) The One who gives salvation to kings, Who delivers David His servant from the deadly sword.**

There are two things that I want us to focus on today that will help us to understand all the ingredients that go into building **“HAPPY PEOPLE.”**

Number one, we should all be aware of the fact that no matter how **righteous** we become, we will always be faced with enemies. As a result of constantly being confronted with enemies, we should become educated on how to pray for our enemies.

Number two, The **blessings** of becoming **“HAPPY PEOPLE.”**

I. A PRAYER OF THE GODLY FOR DELIVERANCE FROM THEIR ENEMIES!

- A.** The Psalmist recounts glorious victories in the past. He also complains that the nation is now beset by strange, barbarous, enemies, so false and treacherous that no covenant can be kept with them.

He prays for deliverance from these enemies, and anticipates the return of a golden age of **peace** and **plenty!**

Now when praying for your enemies, and while fighting this good fight of faith let me remind you of two things; 1) He who trains for war, trains only for wars of which he can approve. 2) He who trains for war punishes those who use trained powers to accomplish their own personal agenda.

First of all notice his **DESCRIPTION OF HIS ENEMIES!**

- 1. THEY WERE FOREIGNERS.** In verses 7 and 11 the Psalmist speaks of them as **“strange children.”**

It seems at this time David was engaged in warfare with some of the heathen nations.

We are not sure exactly what group of people he was referring to here.

The spiritual enemies of the people of GOD are strangers both to him and them.

John 15:18-21 "If the world hates you, you know that it hated Me before it hated you.

15:19 If you were of the world, the world would love its own. Yet because you are not of the world, but I chose you out of the world, therefore the world hates you.

15:20 Remember the word that I said to you, 'A servant is not greater than his master.' If they persecuted Me, they will also persecute you. If they kept My word, they will keep yours also.

15:21 But all these things they will do to you for My name's sake, because they do not know Him who sent Me.

John 16:1-3 "These things I have spoken to you, that you should not be made to stumble.

16:2 They will put you out of the synagogues; yes, the time is coming that whoever kills you will think that he offers God service.

16:3 And these things they will do to you because they have not known the Father nor Me.

2. THEY WERE **DECEIVERS.**

Psalms 144:8 Whose mouth speaks vain words, And whose right hand is a right hand of falsehood.

The words “**deception**,” or “**falsehood**,” would be a better rendering of the Hebrew than “**vanity**.”

So we could modify this verse to say, “**Whose mouth speaketh deceptions or falsehoods, and their right hand is a right hand of falsehood.**”

Now this verse loses its importance and relevance unless you understand that when a Jew took an oath he always raised his right hand to Heaven!

These enemies were swearing falsely, they were covenant breakers! Their most solid engagements were not reliable.

In the present day falsehoods are rampant, and they can be found in almost every province of life, up to, and including the Church.

In every sphere of our lives we are constantly confronted with shams!

The great enemy of GOD, and of “**HAPPY PEOPLE**,” is the original liar, arch deceiver, low down, dirty rotten no-good-for-nothin’, half pint devil known as Lucifer.

John 8:44 You are of your father the devil, and the desires of your father you want to do. He was a murderer from the beginning, and does not stand in the truth, because there is no truth in him. When he speaks a lie, he speaks from his own resources, for he is a liar and the father of it.

2 Corinthians 11:13-15 For such are false apostles, deceitful workers, transforming themselves into apostles of Christ.
11:14 And no wonder! For Satan himself transforms himself into an angel of light.
11:15 Therefore it is no great thing if his ministers also transform themselves into ministers of righteousness, whose end will be according to their works.

2 Corinthians 2:11 lest Satan should take advantage of us; for we are not ignorant of his devices.

3. THEY CAUSED HIM GREAT TROUBLE

The Psalmist represents himself as being in “Great waters.”

Psalms 144:7 Stretch out Your hand from above; Rescue me and deliver me out of great waters, From the hand of foreigners,

This is a Scriptural figure of speech for “Great Distress.”

Psalms 42:7 Deep calls unto deep at the noise of Your waterfalls; All Your waves and billows have gone over me.

Psalms 88:7 Your wrath lies heavy upon me, And You have afflicted me with all Your waves. Selah

The Psalmist does not leave us in the pit of despair, with his enemies exalted but he continues to pray and believe for deliverance from them!

The “**HAPPY PEOPLE**” of GOD sometimes suffer sorely at the hand of the enemy, but don’t despair, for the promise of GOD is that you WILL be delivered!

Isaiah 43:2 When you pass through the waters, I will be with you; And through the rivers, they shall not overflow you. When you walk through the fire, you shall not be burned, Nor shall the flame scorch you.

2 Corinthians 4:7-10 But we have this treasure in earthen vessels, that the excellence of the power may be of God and not of us.

4:8 We are hard pressed on every side, yet not crushed; we are perplexed, but not in despair;

4:9 persecuted, but not forsaken; struck down, but not destroyed--

4:10 always carrying about in the body the dying of the Lord Jesus, that the life of Jesus also may be manifested in our body.

B. Notice with me the specific prayer for “DELIVERANCE FROM HIS ENEMIES!”

This prayer is put together with language that is vigorously and strikingly poetical.

The Psalmist longs for a Theophany, a coming of GOD to judgment, which he describes in language borrowed from Psalms 18:9, 14-16.

David ask's GOD to come upon his **enemies** in the following way's;

1. "WITH DIVINE **MAJESTY"**

Psalms 144:5 Bow down Your heavens, O Lord, and come down; Touch the mountains, and they shall smoke.

David is desiring GOD to deal with his enemies in such a spectacularly Majestical way that his enemies would have no doubt that they had better not mess with him anymore for fear of having to deal with Jehovah on a personal level!

2. "BY DIVINE **POWER"**

Psalms 144:6-7 Flash forth lightning and scatter them; Shoot out Your arrows and destroy them.

144:7 Stretch out Your hand from above; Rescue me and deliver me out of great waters, From the hand of foreigners,

According to the Psalmist the "**LIGHTNING**" is GOD'S arrows.

What David is praying for here is that he would be delivered, and that his deliverance would be carried out by the visible power of GOD.

He wanted GOD to come down in visible form and fight his enemies!

Let me tell you that if you will turn your enemies over to GOD He will defeat them with His Power, but He probably will not do it quite in the way that David wanted it done!

3. "WITH DIVINE **COMPLETENESS"**

In verse 6 He says, "...**Scatter them,Destroy them.**" Then in verse 7 He says, "...**Rid me, and deliver me from the hand of strange children.**"

I would say that David was ready to be free from the influence, and aggravation of these Godless heathen's!

Let me say that when GOD "**SCATTERS**" and discomfits the enemy they are utterly "**OVERTHROWN!**"

By the same token, those whom He delivers are triumphantly saved!

John 8:36 Therefore if the Son makes you free, you shall be free indeed.

John 8:32 And you shall know the truth, and the truth shall make you free."

The LORD is the glorious deliverer of his people from their spiritual foes.

**Romans 8:28-39 28 And we know that all things work together for good to those who love God, to those who are called according to His purpose.
29 For whom He foreknew, He also predestined to be conformed to the image of His Son, that He might be the firstborn among many brethren.
30 Moreover whom He predestined, these He also called; whom He called, these He also justified; and whom He justified, these He also glorified.
31 What then shall we say to these things? If God is for us, who can be against us?
32 He who did not spare His own Son, but delivered Him up for us all, how shall He not with Him also freely give us all things?
33 Who shall bring a charge against God's elect? It is God who justifies.
34 Who is he who condemns? It is Christ who died, and furthermore is also risen, who is even at the right hand of God, who also makes intercession for us.
35 Who shall separate us from the love of Christ? Shall tribulation, or distress, or persecution, or famine, or nakedness, or peril, or sword?
36 As it is written: "For Your sake we are killed all day long; We are accounted as sheep for the slaughter."
37 Yet in all these things we are more than conquerors through Him who loved us.
38 For I am persuaded that neither death nor life, nor angels nor principalities nor powers, nor things present nor things to come,
39 nor height nor depth, nor any other created thing, shall be able to separate us from the love of God which is in Christ Jesus our Lord.**

2 Corinthians 2:14 Now thanks be to God who always leads us in triumph in Christ, and through us diffuses the fragrance of His knowledge in every place.

Romans 16:20 And the God of peace will crush Satan under your feet shortly. The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ be with you. Amen.

C. Notice the Psalmist "RESOLUTION TO PRAISE GOD FOR DELIVERANCE FROM HIS ENEMIES!"

**Psalms 144:9-10 I will sing a new song to You, O God; On a harp of ten strings I will sing praises to You,
144:10 The One who gives salvation to kings, Who delivers David His servant From the deadly sword.**

Notice here:

1. “THE **ASSURANCE** OF DELIVERANCE”

He speaks of GOD as a present Deliverer to him vs. 10 “**...Who delivers David his servant from the deadly sword.**”

He also looks forward with confidence to singing the “**New Song**,” for the new victory.

“**HAPPY PEOPLE**” can be assured of victory in their moral conflicts.

Hebrews 10:35 Therefore do not cast away your confidence, which has great reward.

Hebrews 11:1 Now faith is the substance of things hoped for, the evidence of things not seen.

11:6 But without faith it is impossible to please Him, for he who comes to God must believe that He is, and that He is a rewarder of those who diligently seek Him.

The reason “**HAPPY PEOPLE**” can have such confidence, and expect such complete victory, is because the purposes, the promises, and the power of GOD in Christ Jesus, unite to guarantee it to them.

2. THE **BASIS** OF THIS ASSURANCE OF DELIVERANCE

The Psalmist seems to have grounded his confidence upon GOD’S customary way of doing things!

Psalms 144:10 The One who gives salvation to kings, Who delivers David His servant From the deadly sword.

David knew of GOD’S long standing track record with Saul of snatching victory from the jaws of defeat.

David also knew that GOD had a long standing track record for delivering him from the sword of his enemies.

Let me tell you that what GOD has done in the past, we can expect him to do in the future, in similar circumstances, and to similar characters.

We should be ready to let our GOD’S episodes of deliverance, be to us a pledge for our full and final triumph.

3. THE **PROMISED** SONG OF DELIVERANCE

Psalms 144:9 I will sing a new song to You, O God; On a harp of ten strings I will sing praises to You,

He was saying that the goodness of GOD in this victory will be celebrated by “**NEW SONG.**”

Psalms 40:1-3 To the Chief Musician. A Psalm of David. I waited patiently for the Lord; And He inclined to me, And heard my cry.

40:2 He also brought me up out of a horrible pit, Out of the miry clay, And set my feet upon a rock, And established my steps.

40:3 He has put a new song in my mouth-- Praise to our God; Many will see it and fear, And will trust in the Lord.

This “**NEW SONG**” will be accompanied with the sweet strains of music. He is not only going to sing, but he is going to put his musical ability and effort into it.

We should never fail to let “**NEW MERCIES**” invoke “**NEW GRATITUDE!**”

Then we should allow “**NEW GRATITUDE**” to find its expression in a “**NEW SONG.**”

We should anticipate with confidence the “**NEW SONG,**” of **Heaven.**

Rev. 5:9 And they sang a new song, saying: "You are worthy to take the scroll, And to open its seals; For You were slain, And have redeemed us to God by Your blood Out of every tribe and tongue and people and nation,

II. HAPPY PEOPLE WILL BE BLESSED WITH FRUITFUL OFFSPRING!

A. We regard these verses as presenting a picture of **prosperity** and “**HAPPINESS**” which the Poet desired for Israel.

I can tell you for sure that it is the will of your Heavenly Father for you to experience the “**BLESSINGS**” of “**HAPPINESS**”!

I want us to look at the “**BLESSINGS**” that seem to come to people who have made a commitment to “**HAPPINESS.**”

To begin this segment of this message I want to remind you of two Scriptures;

Proverbs 22:6 Train up a child in the way he should go, And when he is old he will not depart from it.

Romans 4:17 (as it is written, "I have made you a father of many nations"*) in the presence of Him whom he believed--God, who gives life to the dead and calls those things which do not exist as though they did;

Parents, don't ever give up on wayward children!

America is in trouble, crime is on the rise, morals are at an all time low, the economy is in shambles, and our society as we know it threatens to fall apart at the seams.

This is a **“God fearing”** nation, after all we have **“In God we trust”** inscribed on our coins!

Our pledge to the flag states, **“one Nation, under God, indivisible, with liberty, and justice for all.”**

This nation was founded on the right to serve, and worship God as we please, yet those very rights and privileges are being threatened even as we sit in this service this morning!

How could such a thing happen? Many people want to blame the government, the church, the school systems, the politicians, the atheists, or the ACLU.

To some degree theses are partially to blame. However, the reason this has been allowed to happen is because we have failed to **“TRAIN UP CHILDREN IN THE WAY THEY SHOULD GO!”**

The wisest man to have ever lived, Solomon, gives us some advice concerning our children. **“TRAIN UP A CHILD IN THE WAY HE SHOULD GO, AND WHEN HE IS OLD HE WILL NOT DEPART FROM IT.”** The word **“TRAIN”** as it is used here comes from a Hebrew word **CHANAK** (khaw-nak) meaning to narrow.

What Solomon is getting at here is that we should take great pains to narrow down the road that our children travel so that they will follow the path they have grown accustomed to.

The Bible has much to say on the subject of **“NARROWING THE WAY FOR A CHILD.”**

However the child psychologists of our day tell us that the Bible way is too narrow, and restrictive, that you should never correct a child, just use the carrot approach, and you can accomplish your goals.

Sad to say, many people have bought into this theory only to discover that the end result did not produce satisfactory results.

The way of children has not been narrowed, but rather broadened in America, and even within the Church. Here are the end results;

EVERY DAY IN AMERICA

- 1) 7,742 teenagers become sexually active!
- 2) 623 teenagers contract a sexually transmitted disease!

- 3) 2,795 teenagers become pregnant!
- 4) 372 teens miscarry!
- 5) 1,106 teens have abortions!
- 6) 1,295 teens give birth!
- 7) 2,556 children are born out of wedlock!
- 8) 13,500 teens bring a gun to school!
- 9) 10 children are killed by a gun!
- 10) 6 teenagers commit suicide!
- 11) 211 children are arrested for drug abuse!
- 12) 437 children are arrested for drinking or drunken driving!
- 13) 1,512 teenagers drop out of school!
- 14) 3,288 children run away from home!
- 15) 2,989 children see their parents get a divorce!

I for one don't believe the world's system is working! We need to return to Solomon's advice, **"TRAIN UP A CHILD IN THE WAY HE SHOULD GO, AND WHEN HE IS OLD HE WILL NOT DEPART FROM IT!"**

The police department of Houston, Texas, issued a leaflet giving guidelines for raising delinquent children, and it reads like some child psychology books I have seen.

- (1) Begin with infancy to give the child everything he wants. In this way he will grow up believing the world owes him a living.
- (2) When he picks up bad words, laugh at him. This will make him think he's cute. It will also encourage him to pick up **"CUTER"** phrases that will absolutely blow the top of your head off.
- (3) Never give him any spiritual training. Wait until he is 21, and then let him decide for himself.
- (4) Avoid the use of the word "wrong", it may develop a guilt complex. This will condition him to believe later, when he is arrested for stealing a car, that society is against him, and he is being persecuted.
- (5) Pick up everything he leaves lying around – books, shoes, clothes, etc... Do everything for him so that he will be experienced at putting all responsibility on others.
- (6) Let him read all printed matter that he can get his hands on. Be careful that the silverware and the drinking glasses are sterilized, but let his mind feast on garbage.
- (7) Quarrel frequently in the presence of your children. In this way they will not be too shocked when your marriage ends in divorce.
- (8) Give a child all the spending money he wants. Never let him earn his own. Why should he have things as tough as you had them?

Do you think you could produce a juvenile delinquent using this formula? Sad to say this formula is being used to a great degree, right in the church!

"Once there was a little boy. When he was three weeks old his parents turned him over to a baby-sitter.

When he was two they dressed him up like a cowboy and gave him a gun.

When he was three everybody said, **“how cute,”** as he sang a beer commercial jingle.

When he was six his father dropped him off at Sunday school.

When he was eight they bought him a beebee gun, and taught him to shoot sparrows. (He learned to shoot windshields all by himself!)

When he was 10 he spent his afternoons at the convenience store magazine rack, reading anything the clerk would permit him to. His parents were too busy making a living to pay attention to what was going on.

When he was thirteen he told his parents other boys his age stayed out as late as they wanted to so his parents said he could too.

When he was fourteen they gave him a deadly two-ton machine, and used their **“influence”**, to get him a license to drive it, and told him to **“be careful!”**

When he was fifteen the police called his home one night, and said, **“We have your son, and he is in trouble.”** The father angrily responded, **“there must be some mistake, that can’t be MY BOY.”** But.... It was. Does that have any familiarity at all about it?

Let me give an alarming statistic, out of 8,000 delinquent children only 42 attended Sunday school regularly! Is it any wonder Solomon said, **“NARROW A CHILD’S WAY TO THE WAY HE SHOULD GO, AND WHEN HE IS OLD HE WILL NOT DEPART FROM IT.”**

Let me give you a quick recipe for raising good children, who **‘DO NOT DEPART FROM IT’**.

1 cup of **Proverbs 22:6.**

2 Tablespoons of **Proverbs 19:13 “A FOOLISH (Hebrew – keseel = stupid.) SON IS THE CALAMITY (very wickedness) HE FATHER.”**

1 dash of **Proverbs 23:13 “WITHHOLD NOT CORRECTION FROM THE CHILD: FOR IF THOU BEATEST HIM WITH THE ROD HE SHALL NOT DIE.”**

1 gallon of **Proverbs 3:5,6 “TRUST IN THE LORD WITH ALL THINE HEART; AND LEAN NOT UNTO THINE OWN UNDERSTANDING. IN ALL THY WAYS ACKNOWLEDGE HIM, AND HE SHALL DIRECT THY PATH.”**

1 cup of **Titus 2:7 “IN ALL THINGS SHOWING THYSELF A PATTERN OF GOOD WORKS: IN DOCTRINE SHOWING UNCORRUPTNESS, (pure) GRAVITY, (honesty) SINCERITY (genuineness).”**

Add a pinch of **Ephesians 6:4 “AND, YE FATHERS, PROVOKE NOT YOUR CHILDREN TO WRATH, BUT BRING THEM UP IN THE NURTURE (education or training), AND ADMONITION (warning) OF THE LORD.”**

Mix all the ingredients, add a pound of persistence, one cup of love, and stir until right consistency. This recipe is recommended by the creator of mankind.

I pray that this church will continue to be willing to do everything in our power to reach, teach, and keep every child possible. A church cannot go wrong by investing in children! The church that has the heart of Jesus, **“LOVES THE CHILDREN.”**

There is not a parent in this building that does not want their children to grow up and be all that they can be.

“HAPPY PEOPLE” will have sons characterized by **strength**.

Psalms 144:12 That our sons may be as plants grown up in their youth; That our daughters may be as pillars, Sculptured in palace style;

The idea is that of **“young men”** of vigorous and well proportioned growth.

Physical strength is a good thing, but certainly do not believe that is all the Psalmist is speaking of here.

I interpret his meaning to be vigorous young manhood, including physical, mental, and moral strength.

Physical strength is good. Intellectual strength is better. Moral strength is best!

The strength of righteous principles, virtuous habits, holy attachments, and devout aspirations is what really makes a boy become a man!

What greater blessing can be desired of any parents or nation than that it's manhood be of this order?

“HAPPY” are the parents who can turn out son's like this!

When David killed Goliath, Saul said, **“Whose son is this?”** In other words he wanted to know what kind of man could raise a boy like this!

B. “HAPPY PEOPLE” will have daughters characterized by beauty! Vs. 12 **“....Our daughters as corner-stones polished after the similitude of a palace.”** Other translations put it like this: **“Our daughters as corner-pillars, sculptured after the structure of a palace.” “Our daughters as corner-pillars, sculptured to grace a palace.”**

The idea here is that of usefulness: useful as pillars supporting a building, or as corner-stones uniting an edifice.

But the main idea is undoubtedly that of the gracefulness and beauty of the maidens. The Psalmist cannot mean external beauty merely.

- 1) Beauty of **feature** and of form is **desirable**. It is a gift of God. Someone said that beauty is only skin deep, but ugly is to the bone.

We must remember when discussing beauty that there are a lot of pretty people who are not **“HAPPY PEOPLE”**!

A pretty face can become a millstone aiding in a trip to hell!

- 2) Beauty of **mind** and of manner is much more desirable than physical beauty.

This kind of beauty is of a higher order, and more lasting than that of feature and form...

- 3) Beauty of **soul** and **temper** is pre-eminently desirable.

This is the highest kind of beauty that can ever be attained.

This is divine, unfading, and immortal beauty. This is an unmixed, pure blessing.

When associated with moral deformity it becomes repulsive, and in very poor taste.

- C. The highest visible beauty is that of the soul manifesting itself in acts of **human** kindness and **divine** righteousness.

III. HAPPY PEOPLE WILL BE BLESSED WITH SECULAR PROSPERITY!

A. Psalms 144:13-14 That our barns may be full, Supplying all kinds of produce; That our sheep may bring forth thousands And ten thousands in our fields;

144:14 That our oxen may be well-laden; That there be no breaking in or going out; That there be no outcry in our streets.

Several rare expressions occur in these verses, which are of very doubtful interpretation.

It is certain that the Psalmist intended to set forth the idea of great **temporal** prosperity.

- B.** The overall picture here contains Five prominent features:

- 1) **“HAPPY PEOPLE”** are to have well-stored granaries. Vs. 13 **That our barns may be full, Supplying all kinds of produce;** Hebrew – **“From kind to kind.” “Supplying of every kind.”**

The idea is, abundance of all kinds of produce.

It is the will of your Heavenly Father that **“HAPPY PEOPLE”** not want for sufficient provisions as it relates to proper food.

Psalms 37:25 I have been young, and now am old; Yet I have not seen the righteous forsaken, Nor his descendants begging bread.

- 2) **“HAPPY PEOPLE”** are to have fruitful flocks. Vs. 13 **“Our sheep bringing forth thousands and ten thousands in our streets.”** A more correct rendering of course would be **“In our fields.”**

A great part of the wealth of eastern peoples consisted of flocks of sheep.

In old testament times the wealth of a man was measured largely by the amount of sheep he possessed.

- 3) **“HAPPY PEOPLE”** are to have laden oxen. Vs. 14 **“Our oxen strong to labor.” “Able to bear burdens, or laden with flesh.”** The Hebrew is simply: **“Our oxen laden.”**

But with what?

- A) With fat and flesh, so that they will be strong enough to work.
- B) With young, indication that fruitfulness is of utmost importance among the herds.
- C) With the abundant produce.

At any rate the poet is setting forth the great temporal prosperity of an eastern people.

Likewise our Heavenly Father has set forth temporal prosperity for his people.

3 John 1:2 Beloved, I pray that you may prosper in all things and be in health, just as your soul prospers.

The Greek word for Prosper here means, **“to succeed in business affairs.”**

- 4) **“HAPPY PEOPLE”** are to experience the blessing of **settled** peace. Vs. 14 **“....That there be no breaking in, nor going out.”** This has been interpreted, **“going forth to war, or going forth into captivity.”**

What the Psalmist is saying here is that it is the will of your Heavenly Father that the enemy will not be allowed to gain entrance into your life, and that he will not be able to take you prisoner, or to hold you hostage.

These phrases denote a time of profound peace, when no enemy lies before the walls, when there is no need to fear the assault through the breach, no need to go forth to attack the besiegers.

The image here is that of security, peace, order, prosperity.

5) **“HAPPY PEOPLE”** will not be found complaining in the streets!

The image set forth here seems to be that of small groups of people huddled together in the streets complaining because something didn't suit their face.

First of all people who huddle together in small groups and complain, are showing their discontent with themselves.

Secondly they are proving their spiritual inconsistencies, and lack of spiritual maturity!

Philippians 4:11 Not that I speak in regard to need, for I have learned in whatever state I am, to be content:

1 Timothy 6:4-6 he is proud, knowing nothing, but is obsessed with disputes and arguments over words, from which come envy, strife, reviling, evil suspicions,

6:5 useless wranglings of men of corrupt minds and destitute of the truth, who suppose that godliness is a means of gain. From such withdraw yourself.

6:6 Now godliness with contentment is great gain.

Three things that cause people to criticize are:

- 1) **Ignorance**
- 2) **Jealousy**
- 3) **An inferiority complex**

C. The Psalmist here is saying that **“HAPPY PEOPLE”** are people who live in peace and prosperity, and in so doing they have no reason to be found **“in the streets complaining.”**

IV. THESE BLESSINGS ARE VIEWED AS FLOWING FROM THE FAVOR OF GOD!

A. Vs. 15 **“Happy is the people that is in such a case; happy is the people whose God is Jehovah.”** It was common among the ancient Hebrews to regard **temporal** prosperity as an evidence of **Divine** favor.

Prosperity and peace, such as are referred to in the previous verses, are, and must be, the result of following Jehovah with a whole heart!

Peace, order, abundance, a Nation's security and prosperity is directly tied to the worship of Jehovah God.

That which is most certain to make a nation happy and blessed, is to acknowledge God and to keep His laws.

Proverbs 14:34 Righteousness exalts a nation, But sin is a reproach to any people.

B. The Christian's view of the evidence of Divine blessing is truer, deeper, and nobler than that of the ancient **Hebrew**.

God has granted unto us a fuller and clearer revelation of Divine truth. We look for the evidences of His favor in our souls rather than in our circumstances.

We do not trust in well-stored granaries, but in the abounding **"fruit of the Spirit,"** which is in all goodness and righteousness and truth.

We depend on inward joy rather than in outward **"HAPPINESS."**

C. In conclusion, "HAPPY PEOPLE" are those folks who know, and have confidence in their **standing** with GOD.